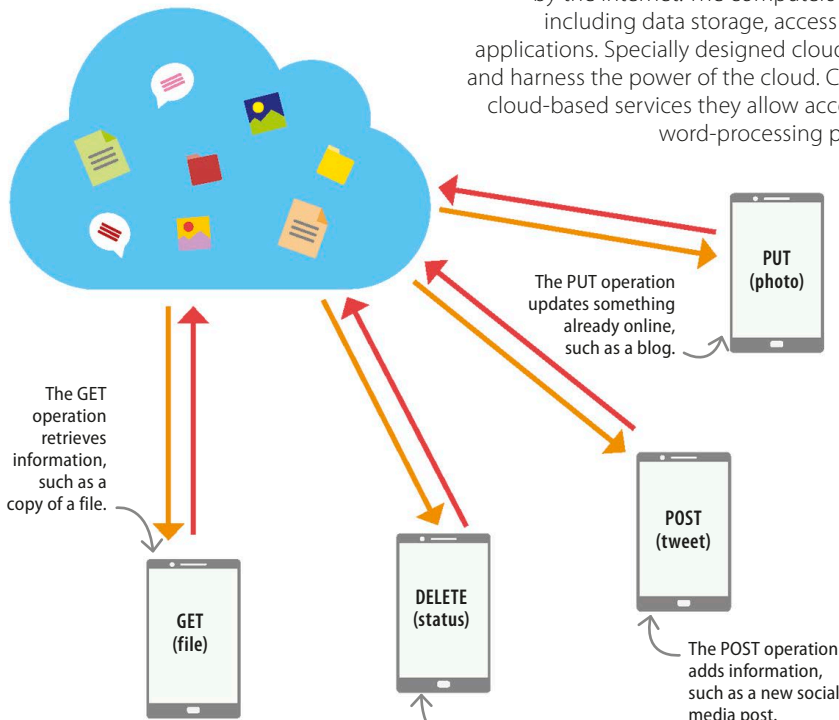


Cloud APIs

The cloud is the network of computers across the world connected by the internet. The computers in the cloud provide a wide variety of services, including data storage, access to very powerful computers, and data analysis applications. Specially designed cloud APIs help programmers access these services and harness the power of the cloud. Cloud APIs are grouped according to the sort of cloud-based services they allow access to. These services include software, such as word-processing packages, and hardware, such as storage space.



Representational state transfer

The cloud computers providing services are known as servers. Other devices, known as clients, make requests for these services using cloud APIs. Most cloud APIs are created using a format called representational state transfer (REST). This means each function performs one of the four standard web operations on data: GET, PUT, POST, or DELETE.

REAL WORLD

Light up tweets

The Twitter API has been used to find out how the world is feeling. A programmer wrote code that monitored the predominant emotions mentioned in tweets from across the world. Anybody can use this code to make their own LED lights glow in a different colour for each emotion.



API security and the Internet of Things

The Internet of Things is the term used for objects in the physical world that are connected to the internet. These items all need APIs that allow programmers to interact with them; for example, by controlling an item or retrieving data created by it. These APIs could potentially all be vulnerable to attack from hackers, giving them access to items in people's homes and cars. To prevent this, APIs have to include a security system, restricting access to those who have a legitimate purpose.

